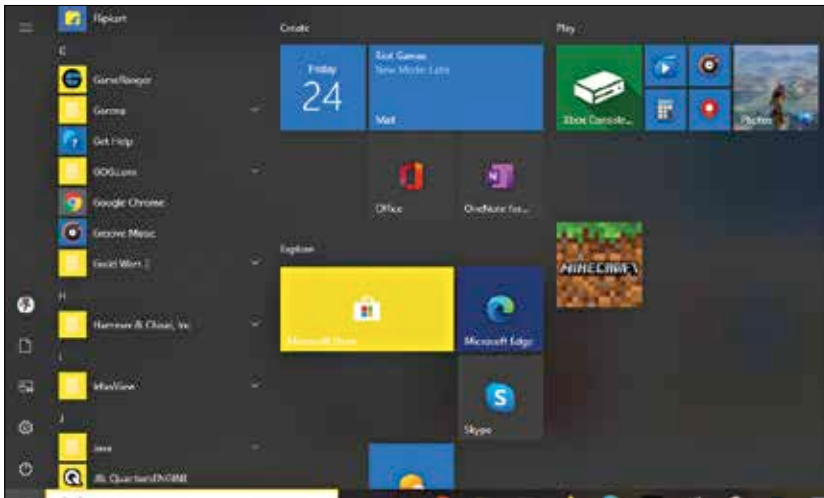




“suggestions”. These are just ads for Windows Store apps which you can purchase. You can get rid of these ads by going to **Settings > Personalization > Start**. There, you’ll find a setting called **Show suggestion occasionally in Start**, simply toggle it **Off**.

ENABLE BACKGROUND SCROLLING

This might be enabled for some, and not for others. In case you fall in the later boat, background scrolling is a very useful tool to have. It allows you to scroll on any window, even if it’s not the active one, as long as you can see some part of the window. This is useful if you’ve snapped two windows to two sides of the screen and are actively working on one while needing to refer to the other. You’ll be able to scroll on the inactive window without needing to actually click on it. In order to turn this feature on, head to **Settings > Devices > Mouse**, here, find **Scroll inactive windows when I hover over them**, and toggle it **On**.

SHOW FILE EXTENSIONS

File extensions are hidden by default on Microsoft. This makes

things difficult for people who often need to look for specific types of files, such as PNGs or JPEGs for example. To always see file extensions on Windows, first open file explorer options, you can access this by simply typing the same in the Start Menu search bar. Once you’re in File Explorer Options, head to the View tab. Here, find the box that says Hide extensions for known file types, uncheck it, and click on Apply, then OK. You should now be able to see all file extensions on Explorer.

USING FOCUS ASSIST

Focus assist is a feature on Windows to help cut down on distractions and focus on the work at hand. It does this by turning off all notifications from apps, contacts etc, and can be fine tuned to your discretion. In order to use Focus assist, head to **Settings > System > Focus assist**. Here, choose from three options, Off – which turns off all notifications, Priority – which allows you to set up a priority list of notifications to pass through, and Alarms only, which turns off all notifications except alarms. This mode can also be scheduled for specific times of

the day, for example, when you know you’re going to be working on something, or even when you’re enjoying your gaming sessions.

SETTING UP DARK MODE ON WINDOWS

Not only is Dark mode cooler than default, it’s also much easier on the eyes. As long as you have the Anniversary Update for Windows 10, which came out August 2016, you should be able to enable Dark mode for your entire OS. In order to turn on Dark Mode, head to **Settings > Personalization > Colors** which will be on the left hand side bar. Here, under the **Choose your colour** drop-down menu, you can select **Dark**. If you want to instead opt for a more custom setup, you can choose Custom here. This will give you two options, with one being **Choose your default Windows color**, and one being **Choose your default app color**. Simply click on Dark for both.

BLOCK WINDOWS 10 UPDATES INDEFINITELY

This isn’t something that’s normally recommended, but in case you want to halt or stall major updates for Windows, be it due to security flaws or performance issues, here’s how you can go about it. If you have Windows 10, you have the option to “Pause updates for 7 days”, however, after a set number of days, the update will force install anyway. You can do this for a total of 35 days before the update is installed. Windows Insiders are limited to 7. In order to fully turn it off though, you will need help from a third-part app. For example, Spydish (<https://dgit.in/spydish>). In addition to letting you fine-tune a host of other Windows features, you can also block major Windows updates. Using Spydish as the example here, simply click on the Analyze button, and under Updates, find Block major Windows updates. Be sure to create a system restore point before you attempt to do so anyway.

DISABLE BING SEARCH

On Windows 10, typing anything in the start menu also does a search for the same on Bing, Microsoft’s search engine. If you’re not keen on

